

Interview Notes - Grandmother caring for grandchildren

1. Can you describe your current experience with purchasing nutrient-dense foods?

As a grandmother raising grandchildren, I sell vegetables for a living. I only buy beans and lentils in small amounts. Milk and eggs are rare treats. My youngest grandchild is underweight, and I worry about nutrition.

2. How do you typically decide where to buy your food?

I buy from the wholesale market when I can save a few shillings, but mostly from nearby kiosks. Digital delivery is not something I consider because I cannot use apps well.

3. Have you ever used a digital platform to purchase food?

No, I have not. I do not own a smartphone, and I also don't trust online services. I prefer to see what I'm buying.

4. If a digital delivery service offered nutrient-dense foods cheaper, how would that impact you?

It would help, especially if I could pay in cash and didn't need an app. But unless it was truly cheaper, I would still go to the kiosks.

5. What are your thoughts on affordability of nutrient-dense foods?

They are too expensive. Eggs at 20 shillings each are not affordable. A fair price would be 10 shillings.

6. Can you describe your current experience with small dried fish or liver?

Small dried fish is sometimes available but often of poor quality. Liver is expensive, so I only buy it once a month, if at all.

7. How do high food prices impact your family?

We end up skipping meals or reducing portions. My grandchildren don't eat meat regularly. Sometimes they only get porridge for dinner.

8. If a digital platform offered fish and liver at lower prices, how likely would you be to use it?

I would be willing if it was cash-based, simple, and trustworthy. Freshness would matter most.

9. What alternatives do you currently use to cope?

I sometimes join chama groups to borrow money, or I cook more filling but less nutritious foods like maize porridge. These do not meet children's needs well.

10. Would you pay a small fee for online convenience?

Maybe 10 to 20 shillings. More than that would be impossible for me.

11. Can you describe accessing nutrient-dense foods for children?

It's very difficult. Doctors advise more protein, but my budget cannot allow it regularly.

12. How do you ensure diverse diet for children?

I try to mix beans and sukuma wiki with ugali. Sometimes I add groundnuts when I can afford them. But diversity is still very limited.

13. What foods do you wish were more accessible?

Milk, eggs, fruits, and fish. These are vital for children's health and growth, especially since they are underweight.

14. If a digital delivery service offered affordable foods, would you use it?

Yes, but only if prices were truly low and I could pay after delivery. Simplicity matters for me.

15. What would you be willing to pay for a service improving diversity?

At most 50 shillings per month, because my income is very small. I would only pay if I clearly saw improvement in the children's diet.